

2000 ▶ 2005

2000

Millennium Seed Bank

This enormous store of seeds, along with partner banks around the world, was launched to conserve seed stocks in the face of any future disasters. The bank aimed to store seeds from 25 percent of the world's plant species by the year 2020. By 2015, 1.98 billion seeds had already been collected under the program.

Seed jars, numbered and barcoded for identification, are stored in dark vaults at -4°F (-20°C)



2001

Segway

Invented by American scientist Dean Kamen, the Segway Personal Transporter (PT) was unveiled on TV. The two-wheeled, self-balancing machine senses shifts of the rider's weight to travel forward or back. The prototype had a top speed of 12.4 mph (20 km/h) and was driven by two electric motors, which lasted up to 11.8 miles (19 km) on a single battery charge.

Young man rides a Segway PT



2001

First space tourist

American billionaire Dennis Tito became the first space tourist when he traveled to the International Space Station (ISS) in a Russian Soyuz spacecraft. Tito spent almost eight days on board the ISS and paid approximately \$20 million for the experience.

▶▶ 2000

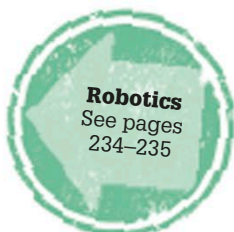


Wikipedia, a free, online, user-generated encyclopedia, was launched in 2001 by Jimmy Wales and Larry Sanger.

2000

First humanoid robot

Honda's Advanced Step in Innovative Mobility (ASIMO) robot gave its first demonstration in 2000. The 47-in- (120-cm-) tall robot could walk, climb stairs, and recognize and grasp objects. Upgrades in 2003 made it the first two-legged robot to run in controlled fashion, later reaching a speed of 5.6 mph (9 km/h).



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2001

First teleoperation using robot

While in New York, Canadian surgeon Dr. Michel Gagner performed a long-distance medical operation on a human patient in Strasbourg, France. Gagner controlled a Zeus robot surgical system from over 3,728 miles (6,000 km) away to remove the patient's gall bladder.

2002

Ice water on Mars

NASA found evidence of water ice on Mars on analyzing data sent back from the Mars Odyssey space probe in orbit around the planet. The mission mapped the distribution of chemical elements on the planet and led to scientists discovering large amounts of water ice buried beneath the surface of Mars's polar regions.

Artist's impression of polar ice caps on Mars

